



Mostly Apples Apple Cake

In this unabashedly apple-forward apple cake, there are so many apple slices and so little batter, you'll wonder how (and if) it will hold together. But never fear: As the batter rises in the oven, it knits those slices together to create a tender cake that's almost creamy and custardy due to the abundance of fruit. Our thanks to Sarah Carey, who developed this recipe, and to Dorie Greenspan, whose Marie-Hélène's Apple Cake inspired it.



PREP

15 mins

BAKE

50 to 55
mins

TOTAL

1 hr 5 mins

YIELD

one 8" or 9"
cake

Ingredients

For the pan

- 1/2 tablespoon butter, softened
- 1/4 cup (30g) sliced almonds, optional

Cake

- 3/4 cup (90g) King Arthur Unbleached All-Purpose Flour or King Arthur Gluten-Free Measure for Measure Flour
- 1/4 cup (24g) King Arthur Almond Flour
- 1 teaspoon baking powder
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- 6 tablespoons (85g) unsalted butter, melted
- 2 large eggs, at room temperature
- 3/4 cup (160g) light brown sugar, packed
- ~~1/2~~ 3/4 teaspoon almond extract* ~~3/4~~
- 3 apples, peeled and sliced about 1/4" thick (4 1/2 cups or 550g)*

*See "tips," below.

Instructions

- ① Preheat the oven to 350°F.
- ② Lightly grease the bottom of an 8" or 9" springform pan or round cake pan (this will help the parchment adhere), then line the bottom with a parchment round. Generously butter the parchment and sides of the pan with the softened butter. Sprinkle with the sliced almonds, a bit at a time, pressing gently to adhere them to the pan. Your coating won't be perfectly even, and that's OK.
- ③ Weigh your flours; or measure them by gently spooning into a cup, then sweeping off any excess. In a medium bowl, whisk together the flours, baking powder, and salt.
- ④ In a large bowl, whisk together the melted butter, eggs, sugar, and extract until creamy, lighter in color, and slightly foamy, about 30 seconds to 1 minute. Whisk in the dry ingredients until just combined.
- ⑤ Use a rubber spatula to fold the apples into the batter until evenly coated. (It will look like there isn't much batter, but don't panic.)
- ⑥ Scrape the batter into the prepared pan and use your spatula to nudge the apples into a mostly-even layer.
- ⑦ Bake until golden-brown on top and a toothpick or paring knife inserted into the center comes out clean, about 50 to 55 minutes.
- ⑧ Remove the cake from the oven and let cool for 15 minutes on a wire rack. Run a paring knife or offset spatula around the edges of pan, then, if using a springform, release sides of pan; or, if using a cake pan, invert it onto a rack or plate, remove the parchment, and turn it back over, top-side up, onto a wire rack. Let cool for at least 15 minutes more. For the neatest pieces, slice with a sharp serrated knife, which will help you saw through the apple pieces rather than crushing them.

- ⑨ **Storage information:** This cake is best served the day it's baked, but it can be stored, uncovered at room temperature, for up to 3 days (press parchment or plastic wrap directly to cut surfaces but don't cover the cake, as it will become damp).
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Tips from our Bakers

- ☆ If you're a super fan of almond flavor, consider increasing the extract to 3/4 teaspoon, but keep in mind that its potency will increase the next day, making any leftovers even more almondy.
- ☆ We find that a mix of Granny Smith and Pink Lady apples offers a nice balance of sweet and sour. But if you're looking for other varieties to use, gravitate to those that are tart and firm. A good rule of thumb? Stay away from any that you can easily indent with your finger (like a Honeycrisp or MacIntosh) — their moisture content will be too high.

We're here to help. King Arthur Baker's Hotline: (855) 371 2253